

Oakwood Educational Academy

December 2024 Newsletter

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Message from Mrs. Mitchell

Dear Parents and Carers,

What a wonderful autumn term we've had! As we approach the Christmas break, I want to thank you all for your continued support and partnership with the school.

Our children have worked incredibly hard this term, and it's been lovely to see them grow in confidence and enthusiasm for learning. From our Reception children settling into school life to our Year 6 pupils taking on leadership roles, every child has something to be proud of.

I hope you all have a restful and joyful Christmas break. We look forward to welcoming everyone back in the New Year!

Warm wishes,
Mrs. Sarah Mitchell
Headteacher

Christmas Play - Final Reminder! ■

Our Christmas production, "**The Inn-Spectors**," will take place on:

Friday 14th December at 6:30pm in the Main Hall

(Please note this is the **confirmed date** - the play was originally scheduled for 12th December but was moved due to a venue booking issue.)

Important details:

- Doors open at 6:15pm
- Please arrive early to find seating (first come, first served)
- The performance lasts approximately 50 minutes
- Children should arrive at 6:00pm via the side entrance in their costumes
- Photographs are welcome, but please no flash photography
- Refreshments will be available after the show

End of Term Arrangements

Last Day of Term

The last day of the autumn term is **Friday 20th December 2024**.

School will finish at 1:30pm on this day (not the usual 3:15pm). Please make sure you have arrangements in place for earlier collection.

There will be no after-school clubs on this day.

Spring Term Start Date

School reopens for the spring term on **Monday 6th January 2025** at the normal time (gates open 8:40am, registration 8:50am).

School Office Closure

The school office will be **closed from Monday 23rd December 2024 until Thursday 2nd January 2025** inclusive.

During this time, there will be no one on site and the phones will not be answered. The office will reopen on Friday 3rd January 2025.

Important: PE Kit Days Update for Spring Term

Please note a change to the PE schedule from January 2025.

Year 4's PE days will change from Tuesday/Thursday to Wednesday/Thursday to accommodate our new gymnastics coach's schedule.

Updated PE Schedule from Monday 6th January 2025:

Year Group	PE Days
Reception	Wednesday
Year 1	Monday and Thursday
Year 2	Tuesday and Friday
Year 3	Monday and Wednesday
Year 4	Wednesday and Thursday ■■
Year 5	Wednesday and Friday
Year 6	Monday and Friday

Reminder: Children should come to school in their PE kit on their designated PE days. They will not need to change at school.

PE kit consists of: White t-shirt, navy shorts, trainers, and during winter months: tracksuit bottoms/leggings and a warm top.

Year 3 Swimming - Spring Term

Year 3 pupils will have swimming lessons every **Thursday afternoon** from **Thursday 9th January** until **Thursday 27th March**.

What your child needs:

- Swimming costume (one-piece for girls, trunks or shorts for boys)
- Towel
- Swim cap (available from the office for £2.50)
- Goggles (optional)

Please pack swimming kit in a **separate, named bag**. They will take their swimming bags with them on the coach and bring them home the same day.

Year 3 will still need their regular PE kit on Monday and Wednesday as usual.

Christmas Jumper Day - Friday 13th December

Don't forget our Christmas Jumper Day this Friday, 13th December! Children can wear their Christmas jumper with normal school trousers/skirt. We're asking for a £1 donation (via ParentPay or cash) which will go to Save the Children.

Lost Property Appeal ■■

We currently have **27 unnamed water bottles**, multiple coats, several lunch boxes, and countless items of PE kit in our lost property box.

Please come and check the lost property (located in the entrance hall by the office) before the end of term. Any unclaimed items will be donated to charity during the Christmas break.

Attendance Matters

Well done to **Year 5** who had the best attendance this half-term at 97.8%!

Whole school attendance this term: 96.1%

Dates for Your Diary - Spring Term

- Monday 6th January - First day of spring term
- Tuesday 14th January - Year 5/6 Young Voices concert, O2 Arena
- Tuesday 4th - Thursday 6th February - Parents' Evenings
- Monday 17th - Friday 21st February - Half-term break
- Thursday 6th March - World Book Day
- Friday 4th April - Last day of spring term, 3:15pm finish

Thank You to Our PTA ■

A huge thank you to our wonderful PTA volunteers who organised the Christmas Fair last week. Despite the rainy weather, we raised an incredible **£847.50** which will go towards new library books and playground equipment.

Wishing You a Wonderful Christmas

From all the staff at Oakwood, we wish you and your families a very Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year.

Thank you for your continued support throughout 2024. We're looking forward to another fantastic year of learning and growing together in 2025!

See you on **Monday 6th January!**

Oakwood Educational Academy
Growing Together, Learning Forever

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